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12/12/23

Observations & Suggestions

As we all know the University of Dubuque has now added a hockey program to the university. Hockey is not a program known to many in the community so as expected engagement is low. In this paper, I will be discussing ways in which the program can increase engagement.

Let's begin with Targeted Marketing, marketing/ branding is everything because that is how you present your brand to the world, and that in turn determines your engagement. Implementing targeted marketing campaigns to reach out to the community and most importantly sports enthusiasts. By using medians like social media, local newspapers, radio, and television to create awareness about the team and the arena. Dubuque's engagement in radio is relatively high so capitalizing on that would be in the best interest of the program.

Community engagement is very important in the success of anything new especially something like an arena. Let's treat the arena like a business. Community engagement is important to a new business. Engaging with the local community by organizing events and activities to generate interest is something the program should consider. Sponsoring local youth hockey leagues such as Dubuques Youth Hockey Association, conducting clinics, and participating in community events such as the winter sculpting show. This helps showcase the team and build a positive image. With a business you need support from other established businesses around you, Partnerships: Establishing partnerships with local businesses, schools, and organizations to create mutually beneficial promotions. For example, offering discounted tickets or exclusive

experiences for employees or students, offering a free dinner for two at a nice restaurant in town if they buy more than ten tickets during the season creates a sense of community and triggers a reward system for the community.

This leads me to one of the most important strategies for a new business, fan Incentives: Offering special incentives to attract fans to the games, such as giveaways, promotional merchandise, or exclusive offers on concessions. Being able to provide a unique game experience that goes beyond just the sport itself is how you gain loyal returning customers who turn to family members of the program and possible future donors. Fan Feedback is also important for the improvement of the program. Actively seeking feedback from fans and implementing improvements based on their suggestions will help focus on creating an enjoyable and fan-friendly atmosphere in the arena. Fan Engagement is the basis of any college program by developing engaging content on social media, such as behind-the-scenes videos, player interviews, and interactive contests. Encourages fans to participate and creates a sense of community online. In this day and age, an online presence is everything, if we can't find you online we are less likely to engage in or participate in any events that are hosted. Local Media Coverage is the program's best friend in this case. Being the only university with a hockey program puts us at an advantage because that's a section of the media that has no coverage. Presenting this to local media outlets as something new for their views is an advantage the other colleges don't have. Reaching out to local media outlets to ensure coverage of the team and surrounding events. Regular press releases, interviews, and feature stories can help generate interest and excitement. The program needs to remember, that building strong connections with the community, fostering a sense of excitement, and providing a memorable experience are key to successfully promoting the new hockey team and increasing attendance at the arena.

Ways to improve the PR class

1. Structure: having the class have due dates would help students with turning things in on time(many students use the calendar on moodle to plan their planners and when things do have due dates they don't show up in the calendar, so students assume theirs no work due)